



# Notes

Jul 13, 2026

# Understanding User Needs w Product

Invited Jade Nakabayashi Brett Connaughton

Attachments 📎 Understanding User Needs w Product

Meeting records 📄 Transcript

## Summary

Ad operations workflow review identified critical bottlenecks with manual order entry and potential for automated campaign reporting.

### **Workflow Inefficiencies and Challenges**

Current manual data entry processes for order forms create significant operational friction. Inconsistent incoming insertion order formats further exacerbate these time-consuming administrative burdens.

### **Recurring Orders and Reporting**

Managing recurring episodes requires extensive manual labor due to system limitations with bulk selections. Disconnected datasets for sales orders and delivery metrics necessitate manual cross-referencing between multiple tabs.

### **Proactive Campaign Performance Analytics**

Integrating delivery data directly into sales views would streamline reporting workflows and eliminate CSV parsing. Proactive visualization tools for campaign under-delivery risks offer significant potential to mitigate compensation issues.

# Decisions

## Aligned

- **Automation focus set on order entry** The team will prioritize automation efforts on initial order entry workflows rather than revision management processes.

We've **updated the Decisions section** using your feedback.

Let us know what you think: [Helpful](#) or [Not Helpful](#)

## Next steps

- ☐ [Jade] Schedule follow-up: Organize additional meeting for later this week to continue reviewing workflows.
- ☐ [The group] Automate insertion orders: Build scraping functionality to read orders and autopopulate fields such as date, impression count, and revenue.
- ☐ [The group] Integrate reporting data: Connect delivery report metrics with sales order views to display performance data automatically.
- ☐ [The group] Visualize campaign status: Create tracking indicators to monitor campaign performance against targets and highlight potential underdelivery risks.

## Details

- **Introduction and Objective:** Jade Nakabayashi, a UX designer, is onboarding to understand the holistic system and ad operations workflows to help optimize product design ([00:01:26](#)). Brett Connaughton, the Director of Ad Operations, agrees to guide Jade through these processes and identify friction points to improve the product experience ([00:02:25](#)).

- **Role and Responsibilities:** Brett oversees a team of three or four people responsible for data entry, vetting, order management, and populating copy and reporting tabs ([00:03:13](#)). Brett notes that these tasks are currently performed manually ([00:04:06](#)).
- **Managing Host-Specific Information:** The team manages unique information for each podcast host, such as clothing and mattress sizes, which is required when brands offer products to hosts ([00:05:02](#)). Because brand-specific product forms vary, the team frequently collects this information manually on behalf of the hosts ([00:05:59](#)).
- **Order Form Inconsistency:** The team experiences friction due to the lack of standardization in incoming insertion orders (IOs). Agencies use varying formats, ranging from simple Google response forms to requests that require manual data entry, necessitating significant email communication and manual tracking ([00:06:50](#)).
- **Manual Order Entry Process:** Brett describes the current order entry process as a significant time sink, requiring the team to manually book spots and input data such as dates, impression counts, and net costs ([00:09:36](#)) ([00:12:50](#)). The team also manually manages ad spot rotation to ensure equitable placement for advertisers, which adds to the manual workload ([00:13:53](#)).
- **Automation for Order Entry:** Brett identifies a need for an automated solution to "scrape" incoming IOs and populate order fields like dates, impression counts, spot revenue, and CPM. Brett emphasizes that even if an automated tool handles these inputs, the team should retain the ability to manually adjust spot positioning when necessary ([00:14:38](#)).
- **Managing Revision Requests:** Revisions are currently tracked by downloading email threads and manually updating records ([00:16:40](#)). While Brett finds this process manageable compared to initial order entry, Jade suggests exploring email integration to automatically flag and populate revision notes ([00:17:45](#)). Brett maintains that optimizing initial order entry remains the higher priority over revisions ([00:18:57](#)).
- **Complexity of Recurring Orders:** Managing shows with multiple episodes per week, such as \*The Daily Show\*, requires extensive manual labor because there is no bulk selection for recurring insertions. Brett explains that shifting these

orders can take hours, as the system slows down when processing 35 to 50 edits at once, which increases the risk of manual errors ([00:19:47](#)).

- **Delivery Reporting and Metrics:** Brett clarifies that "downloads" serve as the core performance metric, encompassing total impressions including streams, YouTube plays, and audio downloads ([00:21:50](#)). The team currently faces a workflow disconnect where they must keep multiple tabs open to cross-reference sales orders with delivery reports, as these two datasets are not automatically linked ([00:24:44](#)).
- **Holistic Campaign Tracking:** Brett suggests that integrating delivery data directly into the sales order view would allow for a holistic look at campaign performance, revenue, and delivery totals on one page. This change would eliminate the need for the team to manually export CSV files and parse data for weekly reporting ([00:25:39](#)).
- **Real-Time Performance Analytics:** Jade proposes implementing graphical visualizations to flag if a campaign is at risk of under-delivering against its targets ([00:27:20](#)). Brett acknowledges the value of such an "on-track indicator," noting that while they rely on \*Podscribe\* for attribution and delivery totals, a proactive warning system would help them address performance issues early and avoid the need to provide free ad reads to compensate for under-delivery ([00:28:05](#)).

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# Transcript

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# Understanding User Needs w Product - Transcript

00:01:26

**Brett Connaughton:** Hello.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Hey, how are

**Brett Connaughton:** Doing good about yourself.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** you?

**Brett Connaughton:** Let me just get you hooked up to headphones. Testing one, two, three.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Hey, how's it going?

**Brett Connaughton:** Perfect. Hi. I'm doing good about yourself.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** I'm well. Thank you so much for taking the time to chat with me.

**Brett Connaughton:** Absolutely. Absolutely. Absolutely. Happy to help.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Um,

**Brett Connaughton:** Appreciate all you're preemptively going to do for us.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** yeah, I know that you have some context on like who I am and what I'm doing, but I'm I'm helping Sam and team out with product.

**Brett Connaughton:** Mhm.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Um, I'm a UX designer. Um, so really just trying to optimize and understand flows. I'm st I'm I'm on boarding right now. So, this is just one step in me like really understanding the holistic system and the way that the business works.

**Brett Connaughton:** Yeah.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** um and really looking to focus on what your workflows are, how you're using Air Table and sort of what you'd like to see in the future vision of the product that we're sort of integrating to sort of live as our like native experience.

**00:02:25**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Um moving off of the Air Table. Um yeah, so I'm talking to a bunch of different people and really just like,

**Brett Connaughton:** Right.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** you know, want to hear about your workflows and how things work. I have some questions here, but this is really time for you to talk about like how things work and what you would like to see. we don't need to like adhere deliberately to the script that I have at all.

**Brett Connaughton:** Mhm.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Um,

**Brett Connaughton:** Okay.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** but yeah, does that all sort of like make sense at a high

**Brett Connaughton:** Um, oh yeah, totally. Yeah,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** level?

**Brett Connaughton:** yeah, yeah, yeah. This is not not my first product development cycle on something like this.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** So, I kind of get the idea of what we're doing here. It's Yeah. Just making sure that I don't my my my issue with these is not my issue. My something I can be better at is sometimes I'll talk about something and you'll go that's actually has nothing to do with what I'm doing here and I need you to check me on that immediately before I go on a tangent.

**00:03:13**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** So, if you go,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** I think it's okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** hey, that's not

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Again, I'm super super new,

**Brett Connaughton:** me.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** so just like understanding the lay of the land and how the business works is very much like part of what I'm trying to understand here, even though we are focusing on like digital product. Um, but maybe we can sort of kick off by you talking a little bit about like what your role is,

**Brett Connaughton:** Yeah,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** um, how long you've been here, and what sort of your primary responsibilities

**Brett Connaughton:** sure. All right. Uh, so I'm the director of ad operations.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** are.

**Brett Connaughton:** I run a team of three or four people, depending on how you count the fourth. Um, and our job is to input all orders into Marley, input all of our vetting requests into Marley, input all of the advertisers into Marley as they come about for vetting requests. Um, almost anything. And we also input all of the like so the orders, data entry, revenue all get inputted by my team.

**00:04:06**

**Brett Connaughton:** We also do all of the copy. So the copy upload tabs are populated by my team and all of the reporting tabs are populated by my team for DAI. We do all of that

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay,

**Brett Connaughton:** manually.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** That sounds like I can already imagine how we could help by doing all the stuff less manually.

**Brett Connaughton:** if yeah, we we've talked about it a million times,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Um

**Brett Connaughton:** but just the ability to upload an IO, an insertion order and have something scrape it and then populate

**Jade Nakabayashi:** yeah,

**Brett Connaughton:** it cuts down hours a week, which so that's kind of for me like the thing where we're like, "Oh, yay." But I

**Jade Nakabayashi:** maybe we can like sort of delve right in.

**Brett Connaughton:** know

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Kate sort of put together a highle workflow, but I would love for you to just sort of sort of walk me through if you can screen share as well and share just the various tools that you use to do some of these things. It would be super helpful for me to see.

**00:05:02**

**Brett Connaughton:** coming

**Jade Nakabayashi:** And then as you do this,

**Brett Connaughton:** up.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** if there are things that are like real friction points, things that you would like to see done differently, please feel free to call that stuff out as well.

**Brett Connaughton:** Got it. Okay. So, I'm just going to walk it through the different tabs that we do use pretty consistently and then I can kind of point out like how we utilize them. So far, I started in February,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Right.

**Brett Connaughton:** so I'm not green, but I'm also not super seasoned on this. So, there are certain things I don't use optimally still because I just haven't found the right path for it yet. Um, so something we also do that I want to point out, we have all of our shows have unique information per

**Jade Nakabayashi:** It was

**Brett Connaughton:** host. So, I'm in the podcast tab. This is something where if we click into this, we start seeing like shirt size, mattress size, like little things like this that allow us to go and answer questions on behalf of hosts.

**00:05:59**

**Brett Connaughton:** something my team has to do a lot of. And you'll meet Mercedes at some point. This is her field. Um, anytime a brand offers product to a host, which is 99% of the time, we have to go and get information or a product form filled out on behalf of the host. So, that could be something where they're like, "Oh, yeah. Well, um, do you use Shopify? Do you have a Shopify storefront?" "Yes." "What's the link to it? Um, are you willing to like what is your bed size? what is your uh XYZ? If you want to do factor or HelloFresh, can you pick your meals and go in and do stuff like that? So something where I kind

**Jade Nakabayashi:** What? So, there's like a product sheet that isn't here that's brand specific that you have to capture once the deal has

**Brett Connaughton:** of each one that is exactly correct.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** been.

**Brett Connaughton:** Yes.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** Once and all of them are unique.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** So, it does live in

**00:06:50**

**Brett Connaughton:** Yeah.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** here.

**Brett Connaughton:** So the well the some of that information lives in here. Um the kicker becomes we would love and I'll show you what I mean by it but each order form comes in a different fashion unfortunately. One agency for one client will do just like a Google response form which is super simple and we can just send a URL and say hey fill this out.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** Um another one asks for manual input of all data and then we email it back to them and they input the order on behalf of the host.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** um which sucks because you're sending out like 18 different emails for and trying to keep everything straight. And then everyone's favorite um clothing sizes which vary by I don't know the way the wind blows on a given day. So that part's always fun.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** that panel that just slid out.

**Brett Connaughton:** Um

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Is that like that's just information that you already have about the host? That's not necessarily correlated to a specific brand partnership,

**00:07:41**

**Brett Connaughton:** yes,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** right?

**Brett Connaughton:** no,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** we just try and do it as we go.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** So, you have to go and like collect all this other information and this is not comprehensive of what you need to know is what you're Yeah. Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** Yeah,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** I'm tracking

**Brett Connaughton:** that's and on top of that, it's one of the things where um we do a there's there's maybe six or seven in podcasting in general. There's about between I guess seven to 10 verticals, so product types that dominate the advertising space,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** and it's not close. Betting, homegoods, clothing, supplements, anything health related, and then mental health.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** Those six alone account for probably and then Shopify is an enigma. It does like 55 million in spending a year. Um those six have seven or eight advertisers within each of them that all have this type need this type of information which is so yeah it's not

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** tied specifically to an advertiser but having a shirt size for a vertical because if Quint or True Classic

**00:08:38**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** reaches out we we try to have this on hand quickly. Um, so this is something where like I said, I'm just walking top to bottom here.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** So, what is that?

**Brett Connaughton:** There's product

**Jade Nakabayashi:** she called like what is the product information stuff that they need called?

**Brett Connaughton:** order form and then like I said,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay, thank you.

**Brett Connaughton:** you'll you'll eventually meet Mercedes said. So, and she can talk much more in depth as to what this looks like cuz this is she she specializes for my team.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Cool.

**Brett Connaughton:** Each person has a section that they do. I have them specialized in each and she does all of our pre-sale. So, she'll do everything with like, hey, here's 25 different hosts, shirt sizes, and addresses and everything else. Um, so I'll go into more of the nitty-gritty stuff. I'm trying to think of what the easiest things to call out are going to be here. Um, we've already got I actually kind of like our advertiser data entry right now because we already have AI that scrapes and runs an advertiser description.

**00:09:36**

**Brett Connaughton:** This is pretty easy to do. Um, because you're just putting in a URL. The AI agent reads the URL and then puts together a small synopsis of what goes on uh or what the advertiser is all about. And then my team can kind of pick and choose the sentences we want to run with. So, this part's fine for right now in my opinion. Um, we'll go to orders. And this is kind of the big thing. So, when we get an IO, and I don't know if pop-ups are going to work for me, but we're going to find out. Uh, 453. So, can you see my screen right now? Does it look like a Excel table? Kind of. Okay. So,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** this is an IO. This is an order form. So, this is when an agency actually places a buy. Have you worked in I guess I should ask, are you familiar with kind of how the podcast advertising field works or is this kind of your first time into

**00:10:35**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** This is my first time into it.

**Brett Connaughton:** it.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** I've had some overviews from other members of the team,

**Brett Connaughton:** Okay.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** but I'm not like, yeah, super savvy in the space.

**Brett Connaughton:** Okay.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** So, treat me

**Brett Connaughton:** Got it. Because I I just want to make sure I'm not just just LE everything. Got it. Okay.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** like

**Brett Connaughton:** Um Yeah. I just want to make sure I'm not talking way over your head technicality wise because then that doesn't help anybody. So, we go to the agency. They say, "Hey, we want to buy the Shawn Ryan show. Here are the dates we've picked. Here's the amount of downloads per date that we want, downloads per episode. Here's the show." Media type, which is the method of insertion of the advertisement. Um, audio and video is just is it going to run on one or both mediums? CPM cost per individual insertion. And then our total net cost. my team has to go in and if we're doing an ad, so say we use that sheet, I now have to go into I have to click I have to manually book the spots through here

**00:11:30**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** and then click each one individually. Make sure they're all clicked. Hope it doesn't buffer because if it buffers and we misalign, it's very hard to tell sometimes. Add the spots to the order via the blue button and then we can go back to the order once everything has been manually done there. I would love. And then well I'll show you from there all that's populated is these two fields I guess these three fields because we just inputed manually which

**Jade Nakabayashi:** I

**Brett Connaughton:** week which position the ad is in.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** warm.

**Brett Connaughton:** And then the type of read for certain hosts we have multiple options here based on the purchase. The default is a 60-second host read with host on camera. Um, for Shawn Ryan, you have to pay extra for him to be on camera at all. Um, if you see how much money that guy makes off of things, it's kind of hilarious. Um, so

we then have to go in, we reopen this doc, and we have to manually input 1.7 million impressions at a \$35,000 ad read cost in all of these manually.

**00:12:50**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Oh my god,

**Brett Connaughton:** Then the CPM autoc calculates.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** that's

**Brett Connaughton:** We then also have to go in and mark if it needs client approval or pre-approval in some way, shape or form um for it to register and send us a reminder that it needs to be done later on. This is a time sync because we will get orders especially.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** So we have certain shows that are five to seven times a week and when you buy them you get all five to seven and there is no way to bulk select anything. It's all manual. So I'll show you an example of what that looks like. So this is kind of like a basic order. So being able to have something scrape the IO as long as and normally you're using uniform terms. So, if we could have something scrape the IO and then at least autod do this,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** the only thing it wouldn't be able to do is spot position because that's something my team does based off of intuition for a read.

**00:13:53**

**Brett Connaughton:** We select this custom every single time. It's never the same twice. This is the only tool that does it.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Is there a way that that could be like suggested or recommended or does that truly need to be like a manual

**Brett Connaughton:** We do fair an equal rotation which basically just means my team goes through and you will never get one first position for

**Jade Nakabayashi:** process?

**Brett Connaughton:** the only specific advertisers get like first position ad first position ad first position ad first position ad. We run it randomly because when we have 19 advertisers per show.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** If you stick one advertiser on the fourth, fifth or sixth ad read every single time, people aren't going to get that deep into the episode. So, we do it at random to then create the easiest way to get the most standard results. Um, we could recommend that it just picks at random against the available spots. That would work. Um,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** And maybe there's like a historical log of like where the spots have been so that it's not doing the same thing,

**00:14:38**

**Brett Connaughton:** that's just sort of

**Jade Nakabayashi:** right?

**Brett Connaughton:** we don't mind if it's the Well, yeah. Within the new edition,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah. was in that time frame.

**Brett Connaughton:** we treat each buy as Yeah. Yeah.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** Because we treat each buy as unique. So, yeah. Once this if if Ultrabooks here but Ultrabooks January through May, we don't take into account January through May on that. We just want to look at the existing B existing batch. But yeah, we just we never want to run the same position twice and if it could just autopop populate this. The easiest way as well to check at the end of the day if it did pop did properly populate. Never going to say that phrase again. Um we can check against

order revenue. it should sum up the total order rev which in turn should match this. So there's always a safety net for human eyes because obviously sometimes AI goose.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** Um but that's how I would love if there was a way we could just pop this into a scraper.

**00:15:40**

**Brett Connaughton:** I call it a scraper. I'm not techsavvy. Um and it just goes, okay, I see dates. I'm gonna randomize position unless told otherwise or my team can fix that at the end of the day. I can read what type of ad it is,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** impression count, spot rev, CPM, and then just toss that on the page because when you do seven or eight shows per buy, this starts to just eat time.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** So, I would love if there was kind of just a drop, let it run. Even if it takes a bit longer to properly run everything through and then we just check on the back end that it looks accurate, that would be great. Um, I will show you what it looks like when we have something.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** So there's nothing in here that you would need to do manually off the cuff ideally, right?

**Brett Connaughton:** Ideally, yes. Um, afterwards we're fine because when we have revisions, which happens pretty commonly, we'll go in and manually assign or do input the revision note.

**00:16:40**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** Totally fine with just doing that manually because that there's a there's a couple steps that I need my team to be wary of when we do that. But if we needed a revision, so say we needed an additional flight added in or a DAI flight added

**Jade Nakabayashi:** But that's like conversation that likely happens in negotiations,

**Brett Connaughton:** inm

**Jade Nakabayashi:** right? That's not going to be necessarily No, it will be.

**Brett Connaughton:** happens after it it'll happen after the fact. So for example,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** say you book 1.7 million impressions on a SH or downloads or impressions on a Shawn Ryan episode and only does 1.2. in order to make that spend whole,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** an agency will ask us to run the missing 500,000 impressions somewhere. So,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** in lie of putting it on the Sha Ryan show, and you'll understand, we treat certain shows very, very differently than other shows. This is one of them because this is our our tent pole show. Um, we'll put in a dynamic order for it where we can run it against the show's back catalog.

## 00:17:45

**Brett Connaughton:** This is a different style of order entry. Um, and I'm going to show you what it kind of looks like for that. But it it makes it harder to kind of scrape because IO's don't typically get updated. We run with the email thread. which I don't have here, but let me see if I can bounce to a different one really quickly just to show you. We download email threads every time a revision needs to be made. We mark it. We reference it up here. And that's how if if a change is made after the fact to minimize the amount of back and forth on paperwork, that's how my team tracks it. I'm fine with that staying the same.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Oh,

**Brett Connaughton:** just the revisions because revisions need context and feeding an

**Jade Nakabayashi:** really?

**Brett Connaughton:** entire which could have up to be 120 to 130 email thread looking for two sentences saying yeah this is good can get a little messy I would not put a priority on anything kind of of that like for specifically for revisions for order entry the initial order entry that's important and revisions are usually also just oneoff requests they're not bulked done.

**00:18:57**

**Brett Connaughton:** Which to me

**Jade Nakabayashi:** But what if there was like a widget in email that you could like flag emails to automatically populate in here to append the

**Brett Connaughton:** means

**Jade Nakabayashi:** reference? Like you're still doing the revision notes manually,

**Brett Connaughton:** if if I

**Jade Nakabayashi:** but it just seems like that's a time suck having to like download them

**Brett Connaughton:** never thought about that.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** here.

**Brett Connaughton:** I never thought about that. If there was a way to flag it and you could integrate Gmail into it and just say like,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** "Hey, Gemini, like mark this for IO 1852 or something," then yeah, maybe if that was it. But I'm just thinking in terms of like where I see the most time suck in what we do. Revisions usually aren't it's order entry.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** is okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** It's the first entry of anything. Um the revision side of things,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** it'll only be one line item that we're adding usually maybe two versus potentially adding 35 at the start.

**00:19:47**

**Brett Connaughton:** Here's another example of so for example, the Daily Show with John Stewart. Um, well, not which do anymore. They run multiple episodes a week.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** We sell in a box of three or a box of five. You can think of it that way. So, if you book an entire year, you take 12 months times between 3, five or seven insertions a week,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** all of it done manually.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** So,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** I see.

**Brett Connaughton:** I had Yeah. so that you can see if it can auto pick up and then work with the ad plan to actually book in episodes throughout the week. That makes life significantly easier because that will put us in a situation where okay, hey, we have to do this. This is one of the only shows where revisions do take a lot of time. I had to shift the two full year buys by two days.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** It took me three hours. Um because you sit there and then eventually when you're making 35 to 50 edits scrolling over and over again, the system is gonna slow down eventually because it's trying to log all that info.

**00:20:55**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** And then you hit save. you then have to go back and reread every single change to ensure that it didn't buffer or skip lag and then you're like, "Oh, I missed one week. Now everything is thrown off." So this is why order entry being that way is important. And there's something else specific to UX I would love to do. We have to do delivery reporting that comes from and I have a hard stop at noon. I I am so sorry,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** No worries.

**Brett Connaughton:** but I am I have a show me.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** We can always schedule more time, too.

**Brett Connaughton:** We will. Yeah. Oh, you and I are going to be best friends very soon. Don't worry about it. Um,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** so if I go into You can't see that because I have to click on it. Um, we have order delivery that gets auto more or less automated and pulled and it's linked to the VIO in the order. So,

**00:21:50**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** you can see here where it says total downloads, it'll give you this information, right? if this could go back and show up on the order itself that it's tied to on the flight. If you just got an additional column that said here's your total downloads that have been logged so far, that would be very helpful. And it's just making that page just making I say in giant air quotes page one talk to page two and create a column for it.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Wait, I'm sorry. I'm kind of lost.

**Brett Connaughton:** Um but let

**Jade Nakabayashi:** What do you What are the downloads? What? Like

**Brett Connaughton:** me yeah so the main metric we use for performance for

**Jade Nakabayashi:** download.

**Brett Connaughton:** a podcast is downloads. That's the number we sell.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Oh,

**Brett Connaughton:** That's our actual go to market metric is

**Jade Nakabayashi:** what's the difference between downloads and streams?

**Brett Connaughton:** downloads.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Is it the same thing?

**Brett Connaughton:** How much time do you have?

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Am I

**Brett Connaughton:** Um it's like when I used to work in SEO it's like what does exact mean?

**00:22:51**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** sorry?

**Brett Connaughton:** You're like, "Well, I mean 55 different things." The idea is downloads will combine streams and YouTube plays when possible. We refer to a download as our core metric. So, if you have YouTube views, um, Spotify streams and Spotify downloads, we will refer to that entire package as downloads or impressions.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay. So, it's just like however the one user is consuming it so it's not counted redundantly. Is that okay?

**Brett Connaughton:** That is exactly true. Yes, that is exactly it.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Thank

**Brett Connaughton:** It's broke and it and it breaks out in column because of two reasons.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** you.

**Brett Connaughton:** One, audio and video are not treated equally in the eyes of advertisers.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Right. Yeah, of course.

**Brett Connaughton:** So, we have to show what our audio and video breakout is. Um, number two is because certain shows we can only sell a portion of what they do. One of our shows, we cannot sell their YouTube,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** but they create a custom MP3 that has all of our ads in So, we can only sell their audio.

**00:23:59**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** And so, having that split out properly allows us to reference the delivery of something much quicker. Because right now, I'm going to go I'm going to switch up how I'm

**Jade Nakabayashi:** So, it's just a unit. It's like a download package. It's not literal.

**Brett Connaughton:** sharing.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Even if you don't download anything and it's just a stream, it's referred to as the download package and that's the unit of sale. Is that right?

**Brett Connaughton:** Yes. Yes, that is correct.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** The easier way if you want to phrase it, if you're talking to everybody would just be impressions.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** I would say you're buying an impre because that's going to match what's in the order IO.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay. Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** We refer to it as downloads because there's certain reasons my team needs to see downloads. But impressions are going to be kind of you can say that's your final metric of this is what we've given you.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** You are buying seven 1.7 million impressions on this.

**00:24:44**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah. I'm talking

**Brett Connaughton:** Great. Okay. So because right now so say we're just checking against the campaign. So this is golden crest medals. This is a fun one. This is an annual. So, this is Golden Crest Medals, 48 flights each. Entering this was a lot of fun. Um,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** That's

**Brett Connaughton:** right now, if I'm just if I'm just looking at the order, I have to go back and forth and try and match the week,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** wild.

**Brett Connaughton:** the different metrics, and I can't see what it's doing here in the order view. So, I need two tabs open if I ever want to check against both. If I want to use my order my actual like

**Jade Nakabayashi:** comparing what

**Brett Connaughton:** hey yeah if I want to find the paper trail for something I have to stay in this order

**Jade Nakabayashi:** happened.

**Brett Connaughton:** it's sales and orders and then if I want to see the performance of something I have to go into reports and go to delivery reporting or delivery reports

**00:25:39**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** to it would be great if on the sales orders tab in the podcast line item for each spot would be the term used. If it could touch or feed this the pods, it'll say podsubscribe download totals as I click. Oh, great. Now it's trying to sort itself. Um to grab the total downloads or in this case, this is interchangeable with total impressions.

It's just the nomenclature used on the delivery report. If it could grab this number and show it here

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** somewhere, it would allow us to look at a campaign holistically in terms of performance, dollars, and everything else on one page instead of going into this, exporting it to CSV. We don't have Office. So then uploading it to Google Sheets, parsing it out, making it readable, and then going back and looking against it.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Let

**Brett Connaughton:** It would be great if we could just have the additional column showing here's your performance or by all means just

**Jade Nakabayashi:** me

**Brett Connaughton:** grabbing all of this these four pieces of information which is total performance So, total impressions, specifically downloads, specifically YouTube views, and specifically Spotify video streams, and just copy this and drop it into here and just make sure it matches based on the date.

**00:27:20**

**Brett Connaughton:** That would be a really great way to see a holistic picture of how any campaign is doing at a given time. Because what we can do from there is if an agency goes, "Hey, we need all this reporting now." Um, and this happens weekly, we then have to go in, grab this,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** double check that nothing was goofy here, that there's no exception or note written about how we're doing something, and then go back to the agency and say, "Here's the weekly reporting." So,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** But I mean, it would probably be nice if there was like something beyond that,

**Brett Connaughton:** having it

**Jade Nakabayashi:** right? where you're able to track in like real time how the progress is going and you don't have to just like view a number against a number in a different like if there's some kind of graphic visualization of this that was like

**Brett Connaughton:** So that that's a very good.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** flagging if you were at risk for not matching a mark or something would that be helpful

**Brett Connaughton:** Yes, it would. Here's the tricky part though.

**00:28:05**

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yes.

**Brett Connaughton:** There's two things to that. But because you're completely right. You are completely right. Um number one, we use a software. Have you ever Have they introduced you to Podscribe yet? I bet probably not.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** No.

**Brett Connaughton:** Podscribe is our industry standard reporting tool.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** No.

**Brett Connaughton:** Um, we do something called attribution on everything. Attribution drops a cookie into every single podcast that we run

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** and that is how advertisers see clickth through. That's how they retarget. They use your IP address. We can target everything. It's terrifying. It's very big brother. Um, we can ODScribe is the industry standard for this. It is what everyone uses. So,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** we have right now I believe the way it's set up is and you can see right here total plays which is our download total.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** Um, this is what it's scraping. This is what that delivery report is scraping.

**00:29:01**

**Brett Connaughton:** This is what it's looking for. So, it's coming into here and grabbing that data and those APIs are talking to each other.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** Um, so this only updates I think it's I'm not sure what their

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** refresh rate is. It's not instant obviously. I think it's a maybe an eight or 10 hour cycle, maybe 12 to get updated.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Oh, okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** So I would love I what you're what you're referring to is an OTI,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Well,

**Brett Connaughton:** an on-track indicator. Um, we it's harder to do with downloads because of the nature of Oh my god, that's streamion.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Mhm.

**Brett Connaughton:** There we go. Nope, I did it again. I'm gonna stop sharing. Um, I would love something like that. Uh, we can do it for what's called DAI and we can talk about DAI a bit further another time because we kind of have a Google sheet with a bunch of equations that does it for us. um as long as we input the data.

**00:29:58**

**Brett Connaughton:** But for downloads, because there's, you saw three different buckets leading into our total, it's a little bit harder to do. So,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** you would need to link up two different APIs and YouTube to give the delivery total there and then run an equation that tells you where you are against what you're doing. So,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** there's more though. Um, and the just to point out the ways you're pointing things out. You understand this.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Oh,

**Brett Connaughton:** I'm just telling you now. You know, you know what's happening here because you're reading it how I'm reading it. So, I just want to let you know like,

**Jade Nakabayashi:** good.

**Brett Connaughton:** oh, would it be cool to see like something that tells you, hey, we're falling behind here. Yes, it would be. For most of our ads, there's nothing we can do except give them the number and to let them ask us for something, but you're seeing it the right way. It's nice to know because when we're looking at monthly downloads for a show, if we see them trending downward, we need to be cognizant of that when we're selling them in the future that, hey, 150 is no longer a thing. Now it's 110

**Jade Nakabayashi:** So what are they going to ask you to do if it's trending downwards and like you have to adjust something? You said that there's nothing that you can do.

**Brett Connaughton:** free ad read.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** What will they ask do?

**Brett Connaughton:** We have to give them a free ad read and that is a whole thing.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Okay.

**Brett Connaughton:** So that that that gets a lot of push back because you're taking away monetizable inventory to make up for something that you sold. So that's where I specifically and my team have to we get to play the people game uh

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah.

**Brett Connaughton:** and talk to people about these things. All right, I do have to bounce. Can you set some more time with me later this week?

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Yeah, I will. Thank you so much for your time.

**Brett Connaughton:** You're awesome. This is going to be awesome.

**Jade Nakabayashi:** Thanks. Okay. Bye.

# Transcription ended after 00:31:41

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